Hermes Agent Vault Cheatsheet

How to set up a notes vault with Hermes Agent: 13 tasks, each with the steps to do it.
Automata Learning Lab

CONTENTS

1. Create vault in Hermes
2. Save to vault with a skill
3. Meeting notes from Google Meet recordings in Hermes
4. Research reports and summaries in Hermes
5. Web clippings in Hermes
6. Decisions log in Hermes
7. Daily notes in Hermes
8. Project files in Hermes
9. PRDs for apps and prototypes in Hermes
10. Workflows and SOPs in Hermes
11. Concept and synthesis pages in Hermes
12. Atomic and evergreen notes in Hermes
13. Session memory in Hermes

1 Create vault in Hermes

> Goal: a folder of markdown notes that Hermes can read and write.

1. Use the folder `~/.hermes/hermes-notes` as the vault. Open it in Obsidian as a vault.
2. Tell Hermes the path. The `obsidian` skill reads `OBSIDIAN_VAULT_PATH` from `~/.hermes/.env`. Add that line yourself. The fallback is `~/Documents/Obsidian Vault`.
3. Ask Hermes: "list the notes in my vault". It uses `search_files` on the path.
4. Link notes with `wikilinks`.

Related: Save to vault with a skill

Source: Hermes `obsidian` skill.

2 Save to vault with a skill

> Goal: a skill that saves things to the vault. Basic wiki idea, no fancy setup.

1. Use the bundled `obsidian` skill for read, search, create, append and wikilinks. It works with `read_file`, `write_file`, `patch` and `search_files`.
2. Add the `llm-wiki` skill only if you later want `SCHEMA.md`, `index.md`, `log.md` and a `raw/` folder. Skip it for now.
3. Write one small skill for your own rules. Ask Hermes: "create a skill that saves X to my vault with this file-name pattern". Hermes writes it with `skill_manage` into `~/.hermes/skills/`.
4. Invoke it with `/<skill-name>` or by name.
5. Every skill is a folder with a `SKILL.md` (name, description, steps).

Related: Create vault in Hermes, Concept and synthesis pages in Hermes

Sources: Skills System docs, Creating Skills docs, `llm-wiki` skill.

3 Meeting notes from Google Meet recordings in Hermes

> Goal: new Google Meet recordings become meeting notes automatically.

1. Connect Google Drive through the `google-workspace` skill (OAuth2). It covers Gmail, Calendar, Drive, Docs and Sheets.
2. Find the Meet Recordings folder in Drive and test: "list the newest file in Meet Recordings".
3. Write a skill that transcribes the recording, then runs the `meeting-action-items` skill (decisions, owners, tasks with citations). Save the result into the vault as `Meeting Notes - <title> - YYYY-MM-DD.md`.
4. Schedule it with cron: `hermes cron add`, for example "every weekday 18:00". Attach the skill to the job. Deliver the result to a local file.
5. Cron limits: 3 minute hard interrupt per run and `skip_memory=True` by default. Keep the job small. Use a pre-run `script` to find new files first.

> Untested: Hermes docs list no Google Meet specific skill. The transcription step needs a tool you choose (for example whisper.cpp). This chain is untested end to end.

Related: Daily notes in Hermes

Sources: Cron docs, background systems reference, `google-workspace` and `meeting-action-items` skills.

4 Research reports and summaries in Hermes

> Goal: Hermes researches a topic and files a cited report in the vault.

1. Make sure web tools are on: `hermes tools`. Search and extract work with several backends, including free self-hosted SearXNG.
2. Ask: "research X and save a summary to my vault with sources".
3. Use the `grounded-citations` skill so every claim carries a source. Use `arxiv` for papers.
4. For big topics, `delegate_task` runs sub-agents in parallel (default cap 3 children, `delegation.max_concurrent_children`).
5. Name files `Research - <topic>.md` and link related notes.

Related: Web clippings in Hermes

Sources: Web Search docs, Delegation docs, skills list.

5 Web clippings in Hermes

> Goal: save web pages as markdown notes.

1. Ask: "clip <url> into my vault". Hermes uses `web_extract` (clean markdown, works for PDFs).
2. If a page blocks the fetch, the `blocked-page-recovery` skill handles 403, paywall and bot walls. The browser tool is the fallback.
3. Save to a `Clippings/` folder in the vault. Add the source URL and date at the top.
4. Long pages are truncated in chat. The full text is saved to disk, so ask Hermes to write it to the note directly.

Related: Research reports and summaries in Hermes

Sources: `web_extract` tool behavior, Browser docs.

6 Decisions log in Hermes

> Goal: one place that records why you chose X.

1. Create `Decisions Log.md` in the vault. Format per entry: date, decision, reason, rejected options.
2. Tell Hermes the rule once in `AGENTS.md` or in a small skill: "when we decide something, append it to Decisions Log.md".
3. Append with `patch` (anchored) so old entries stay untouched.
4. Don't use Hermes memory for this. `MEMORY.md` holds 2,200 characters and `USER.md` 1,375, which is too small for a log.

Related: Session memory in Hermes, Project files in Hermes

Sources: Memory docs, Obsidian skill.

7 Daily notes in Hermes

> Goal: a daily note created (or filled) automatically.

1. Pick a name pattern, for example `Daily - YYYY-MM-DD.md`.
2. Create a cron job, for example `0 8 * * *`. Schedules accept 5-field cron, "every monday 9am", durations or timestamps.
3. Prompt for the job: create today's note from a template, add calendar events (via `google-workspace`) and open tasks.
4. Use `workdir` so the job loads your `AGENTS.md`. Use `script` for pre-run data collection.
5. Cron runs in a fresh session with no memory. Put everything the job needs in the prompt, the skill or the template.
6. Manage jobs with `hermes cron list`, `pause`, `resume`, `run`, `remove`, or in plain language in chat.

Related: Meeting notes from Google Meet recordings in Hermes, Create vault in Hermes

Sources: Cron docs, background systems reference.

8 Project files in Hermes

> Goal: each project has a central note and a rules file Hermes loads automatically.

1. Put an `AGENTS.md` in each project folder. Hermes loads it from the working directory at session start. It also picks up files in subfolders as it navigates.
2. Load order (first match wins): `.hermes.md`, `AGENTS.override.md`, `AGENTS.md`, `CLAUDE.md`, `.cursorrules`. Your existing `CLAUDE.md` files work.
3. Outside a git repo, only the working directory is checked.
4. Create a vault note `Project - <name>.md` with status, goal, links and next step. Ask Hermes to update it at the end of a session.
5. Use `@folder:` and `@file:` references to attach context in a message.
6. Keep global voice and tone in `~/.hermes/SOUL.md`.

Related: PRDs for apps and prototypes in Hermes, Decisions log in Hermes

Sources: Context Files docs, Context References docs.

9 PRDs for apps and prototypes in Hermes

> Goal: a short product requirements doc before building anything.

1. Make a template note `PRD Template.md`: problem, user, scope, non-goals, acceptance checks.
2. Write a small skill, for example `prd`, that fills the template from a rough idea and saves `PRD - <app>.md`.
3. Use the bundled `spike` skill to test a risky assumption with a throwaway experiment before the build.
4. Link the PRD from the project note. Ask Hermes to plan first and stop at the plan if you want review.
5. Use `test-driven-development` once the build starts.

Related: Project files in Hermes

Sources: bundled skills list, Skills System docs.

10 Workflows and SOPs in Hermes

> Goal: repeatable procedures Hermes can follow.

1. A skill is a procedure. Write each SOP as a skill (`SKILL.md` with steps) in `~/.hermes/skills/` . Ask Hermes to create it after you finish a task once.
2. Hermes also saves non-trivial workflows as skills on its own (procedural memory).
3. Keep a readable copy in the vault as `SOP - <name>.md` if you want to browse it in Obsidian.
4. Run an SOP on a schedule with a cron job and the skill attached.
5. `hermes curator status` shows skill usage. The curator archives idle agent-created skills and never deletes them. Pin the ones you want to keep.

Related: Daily notes in Hermes, Project files in Hermes

Sources: Skills System docs, Curator docs.

11 Concept and synthesis pages in Hermes

> Goal: pages that combine several sources into one idea.

1. Use the `llm-wiki` skill. It keeps `concepts/` and `comparisons/` pages with `wikilinks` , an `index.md` and a `log.md` .
2. Set `WIKI_PATH` in `~/.hermes/.env` to the vault folder (add the line yourself).
3. Ask: "ingest this source" or "query the wiki about X". The skill reads the index first, then the relevant pages.
4. Create a page only when a concept shows up in 2+ sources or is central to one.
5. Link each page to at least 2 others. File good answers back as pages.

Related: Atomic and evergreen notes in Hermes, Save to vault with a skill

Sources: `llm-wiki` skill (Karpathy's pattern).

12 Atomic and evergreen notes in Hermes

> Goal: one idea per note, written so it stays useful.

1. Give Hermes the rule: one idea, a title that states the idea, 2+ `wikilinks`.
2. Ask: "turn this transcript into atomic notes". Hermes splits it and writes each file with `write_file`.
3. Search for an existing note first (`search_files`) to avoid duplicates.
4. Review the notes yourself. For protected activities like learning and thinking, write the final wording yourself.

Related: Concept and synthesis pages in Hermes

Sources: `obsidian` and `llm-wiki` skills.

13 Session memory in Hermes

> Goal: Hermes remembers across sessions.

1. Built-in memory has two files in `~/.hermes/memories/`: `MEMORY.md` (2,200 chars, agent notes) and `USER.md` (1,375 chars, your profile). The agent edits them with the `memory` tool.
2. Memory loads as a frozen snapshot at session start. New entries appear next session.
3. Past sessions live in `~/.hermes/state.db` (SQLite with full-text search). Resume with `hermes --continue` or `hermes --resume <id>`.
4. For long term storage beyond the limits, write to the vault (see Decisions log in Hermes) or add an external memory provider plugin (Honcho, Mem0 and others).
5. Don't point two agent processes at the same Hermes home. Use a profile for a second agent.
6. Cron sessions skip memory by default.

Related: Decisions log in Hermes, Project files in Hermes

Sources: Memory docs, Memory Providers docs, `hermes-agent` skill.

Source: Hermes Agent docs (hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs). Steps were not all tested end to end.